

Did AI Just Steal Your Call?

Why more customers are asking AI before they call you — and how to make sure you're the one they land on. A short guide for South Florida SMB owners.

The new front door

Ten years ago, a customer found you through Google or a neighbor's recommendation. Today, a growing share ask ChatGPT, Gemini, or Google's AI directly: *"who's the best service near me?"* That AI answer has become your new front door.

Here's the uncomfortable part: **if AI doesn't know about you, it can't recommend you.** And it won't tell you it left you out. Your customers just quietly go somewhere else.

What a missed service really costs

What happens	Typical cost
Missed call — customer calls your competitor	\$1,000+ lifetime value lost
No response for 24 hours — they book elsewhere	100% of that job
AI recommends the shop next door instead of you	Every future call they'd have made

The math: businesses miss roughly 27% of calls. A service business that fixes its lead response can stop thousands of dollars leaking every month — just by answering fast.

What the winners do

- **Answer every lead in under 60 seconds.** Speed is the single biggest factor in who gets the job.
- **Text back missed calls instantly.** Callers who get a reply within 5 minutes are far more likely to connect.
- **Make sure AI knows about you.** Consistent name/address/phone + reviews + clear service pages across the web.
- **Go 24/7.** The 2 AM call that used to hit voicemail can now book an appointment.

Want to know if AI is recommending **you** right now?
Take the free 60-second AI Visibility Score at theonegroup.info/ai-visibility-score

The One Group.AI — AI Visibility Audits, Optimization & Coaching for South Florida SMBs. August 2026 · akennedy@theonegroup.info
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